

Mercury MP3-VCD Player

Entertainment in your palm

The sleek and rounded translucent front of this MP3 and VCD player is bound to attract your attention. It has an aqua coloured front panel and you can see the media spinning within. It also houses chrome-plated control buttons for Play, Volume, Rewind, etc. The LCD screen does not support ID3 tags and displays information such as the track number, time, Electronic Shock Protection (ESP) status and mode (repeat-one, repeat-all and random). The player has a DC 5V power connector, earphone jack and Video and Line Out jack with labels clearly indicating the function of each. The player offers good audio quality across the board, be it a song with heavy instrumentals or vocals. The bundled earphones delivered all the frequencies very well. The player comes with an RCA cable (audio and video cable) for connecting to the TV to play



the VCD. The sleek looking remote lends that extra comfort of operating the unit while enjoying a movie. The power adapter and bundled rechargeable NiMH batteries translate into money saved.

On the negative side, the documentation is meagre on information and is not of much help. No carry case was bundled with the player, which makes it susceptible to scratches and damage from impact. All in all, at just Rs 5,000, the Mercury MP3-VCD Player is a good solution if you don't wish to spend big bucks on a full fledged VCD system and also want mobile audio.

SPECIFICATIONS

Supports MP3 and VCD formats; plays CD-R and CD-RW media; 50 second shock protection buffer; infrared remote control; repeat one/repeat all/random play modes; 32, 44.1 and 48 KHz sampling rates

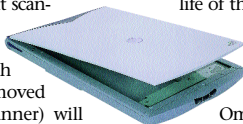
Mercury MP3-VCD Player B+	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Price: Rs 5,000
Contact: Visualan Technologies
Phone: 022-8202688
Fax: 022-8368514
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Canon CanoScan N1240U scanner

The slim beauty

The latest offering from Canon in the CanoScan series is the N1240U, an ultra slim and silent scanning device. The Z-lid (the lid which can be removed from the scanner) will allow you to scan larger, three-dimensional objects with extreme ease. The device derives power through the USB port and has a built-in



power saving mode that will not only save on electricity bills, but will also enhance the life of the device.

The package includes a whole bunch of applications such as Omnipage Pro 9, Arcsoft Photobase and PhotoStudio 2000, which make it easy for OCR-ing documents or for scanning images. The scanner was recognised

immediately on the Windows XP Professional system and its drivers were installed from the bundled CD.

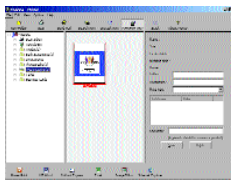
The CanoScan N1240U took 100 seconds to scan a full colour image (A4 size) at 300 dpi, which is quite slow. At 22 seconds, its preview time is also not too impressive—a scanner in its price range should take about

Price: Rs 9,995
Contact: Canon India Ltd
Phone: 011-6806572
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ViciDocs Pronto

File it up

Ever wanted an application that could manage and archive your hardcopies as well as electronic documents in a



common repository? ViciDocs Pronto could be the solution for you. The program uses MS Access for managing its database and allows you to capture documents via an attached scanner. It comes with a built-in viewer which supports 150 file formats including Word, Excel, PDF and AutoCAD's DWG. This means that the documents can be viewed and printed from within the database even without the native application.

Customisable templates with pre-defined fields such as date, author, keywords and so on, make document

Price: Rs 12,000
Contact: ViciSoft Technologies P Ltd
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Web site: www.vicisoft.com

10 seconds to preview an image. Though slow, the scanner's colour reproduction was bright and vibrant.

SPECIFICATIONS

1200x2400 optical resolution, USB interface, 48-bit colour depth and a CD containing ScanGear, OmniPage Pro 9, Arcsoft Photobase and PhotoStudio 2000

CanoScan N1240U B+	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

management child's play. Advanced users can create their own databases with customisable fields. The application also provides shortcut keys to some of the major Office and Internet applications such as Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Internet Explorer and so on, making it easier to work with.

The interface is a little tough and the preferences option only provides very basic View and Import preferences settings. Another feature lacking is that in the Metadata View, you can only access files till the root folder level of ViciDocs—any other folder is inaccessible.

To conclude, here is one application that began as a great concept but was let down by a poor interface and has a long way to go before it makes for a good purchase.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Windows 9x and above, Pentium II class processor, 32 MB RAM, 30 MB disk space

ViciDocs Pronto B-	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶